

PAID • REMOTE • NO VISA REQUIRED

STIPEND TIMETABLE

Every open-source program that pays a student abroad, and the month you have to be standing there when it opens.

COMPILED 4 Sep 2026 NEXT WINDOW 1 Oct – Hacktoberfest
NEXT PAID WINDOW Feb 2027 – Outreachy RUNWAY 21 weeks

THE CALENDAR IS EMPTY UNTIL FEBRUARY. THAT'S THE GOOD NEWS.

Outreachy's December cohort closed on 31 August, and GSoC doesn't publish its organisation list until mid-February. So there is nothing to apply to this week — which is exactly the position you want, because none of these programs are won inside their application window.

WINDOWS ARE SHORT. PREP IS LONG.

GSoC's contributor window is roughly two weeks in late March. The people selected in it started contributing to their organisation in December. Applying cold in March is applying to lose.

ONE ORG, MANY PROGRAMS.

KDE, GNOME, Wikimedia, Rust and most CNCF projects each participate in three or more of these programs. Pick one codebase and a single contribution history becomes five separate applications.

MENTORS PICK NAMES THEY KNOW.

Selection is a maintainer choosing from people whose patches they have already reviewed. The proposal mostly confirms a decision that was made in the issue tracker months earlier.

TIMETABLE

September 2026 through September 2027. Anything marked **EST** is projected from the 2026 cycle — organisers had not published 2027 dates at the time of writing. Confirm each one on the official site before relying on it.

SEP
2026

No paid windows open. This is the build month — pick an organisation and get its source tree compiling locally.

Outreachy · December cohort \$7,000
CLOSED Initial applications closed 31 Aug · internship runs 7 Dec – 8 Mar

OCT
2026

Hacktoberfest unpaid
OPENS 1 OCT 1–31 Oct · four merged PRs · a forcing function, not a credential

NOV
2026

Quiet month. Keep landing patches — November is what decides February.

DEC
2026

Season of KDE certificate
EST Applications ~Dec · runs Jan–Mar · the on-ramp into KDE, which also runs GSoC and Outreachy

24 Pull Requests unpaid
1–24 Dec

JAN
2027

LFX Mentorship · Spring term

\$1,000–6,600

EST Applications ~Jan–Feb · term runs Mar–May · up to 3 projects

Summer of Bitcoin

\$3,000–6,600

EST Applications open ~late Jan · paid in BTC · university students

FEB
2027

Outreachy · May cohort, initial application

\$7,000

HIGHEST VALUE EST ~2-week window, early Feb · then a contribution period through March

GSoC · accepted organisations published

—

EST ~mid-Feb · the starting gun, not the deadline

Igalia Coding Experience

€7,000

EST Opens ~late Feb · 450 hours over 3–6 months · students and self-taught both eligible

Open Summer of Code

variable

EST ~Feb · EU residents only

FOSSEE Summer Fellowship

stipend

EST ~Feb–Mar · IIT Bombay · largely India

MAR
2027

GSoC · contributor applications

\$1,500–6,600

HARD DEADLINE EST ~2 weeks, second half of March · up to 3 proposals · results ~1 May

Outreachy · contribution period

\$7,000

Recorded contributions decide it · final application due at period end

Summer of Bitcoin · deadline

\$3,000–6,600

EST ~March · program runs May–Sep

GirlScript Summer of Code

unpaid

EST ~March · India

APR
2027

Igalia Coding Experience · deadline €7,000

EST ~3 Apr · graphics, JS DevTools, GStreamer, web standards, Linux packaging

Ethereum Protocol Fellowship · Cohort 8 monthly

EST Applications ~Apr-May · 5 months · remote, plus sponsored travel

Code for GovTech (C4GT) ₹100,000

EST ~April · India / digital public goods

OSPP · project list published ¥4,000–12,000

EST ~April · program runs through November

MAY
2027

GSoC results —

EST ~1 May · coding begins late May

OSPP · student registration ¥4,000–12,000

EST Opens ~May · university students worldwide · paid in USD by SWIFT

EPF · deadline monthly

EST ~mid-May

JUN
2027

OSPP · student application deadline ¥4,000–12,000

EST ~early June

MLH Fellowship · Fall batch need-based

EST Applications ~Jun-Jul · rolling, closes weeks before the batch starts · 12 weeks

LFX Mentorship · Summer term \$1,000–6,600

Term runs Jun-Aug

**JUL-AUG
2027**

Outreachy · December cohort, initial application

\$7,000

SECOND SHOT

EST ~August · the one you just missed this year

LFX Mentorship · Fall term

\$1,000–6,600

EST

Applications ~Jul-Aug · term runs Sep-Nov

Linux Kernel Mentorship

unpaid tier

EST

~Jul-Aug · hardest program listed here, largest signal

**SEP
2027**

Cycle restarts — and this is also when Summer 2028 internships open at the European offices that do sponsor visas.

EVERY PROGRAM, SIDE BY SIDE

Stipends at GSoC and LFX are adjusted for purchasing power in your country of residence, so what you receive depends on where you live, not where the project is.

PAID — OPEN TO APPLICANTS WORLDWIDE

PROGRAM	STIPEND	LENGTH	CADENCE	WHO CAN APPLY
Outreachy	\$7,000	3 months	Two cohorts — May & Dec	Anyone underrepresented in tech in their own country. Not student-only. Must be free of other full-time commitments during the internship.
Igalia Coding Experience	€7,000	450 hrs / 3–6 mo	Annual, opens ~Feb	Students in formal education <i>or</i> self-taught. Five technical areas only.
Google Summer of Code	\$1,500–6,600	12 or 22 wks	Annual, apply ~Mar	18+, new to GSoC. Student status not required since 2022.
LFX Mentorship	\$1,000–6,600	12 weeks	Three terms a year	No student requirement. Max 3 projects per term. CNCF, Kubernetes, kernel and much more.
Summer of Bitcoin	\$3,000–6,600	~3 months	Annual, apply ~Feb–Mar	University students. Paid in BTC.
Google Season of Docs	\$5,000–15,000	~6 months	Annual	Technical writers. Paid to the org, which then hires you. Badly underused route if you write well.
Ethereum Protocol Fellowship	negotiated	5 months	Annual, apply ~Apr–May	Open. Protocol-level work: clients, specs, testing.

PROGRAM	STIPEND	LENGTH	CADENCE	WHO CAN APPLY
MLH Fellowship	need-based	12 weeks	Three batches a year	Open globally. Amount varies by track and country of residence.
OSPP	¥4,000–12,000	~3 months	Annual, apply ~May–Jun	University students worldwide. Chinese Academy of Sciences program; pays international students in USD by SWIFT.

REGION-GATED, AND UNPAID PROGRAMS WORTH THE TIME ANYWAY

PROGRAM	PAYS	WHEN	WHY IT'S ON THE LIST
Code for GovTech	₹100,000	~Apr	India / digital public goods ecosystem. Check eligibility before investing time.
FOSSEE Fellowship	stipend	~Feb–Mar	IIT Bombay, largely India.
Open Summer of Code	variable	~Feb	Belgium/EU residents, with an in-person component.
Season of KDE	no	~Dec	The recognised entry path into KDE — which then runs GSoC, Outreachy and Season of Docs. The cheapest ticket into a multi-program org.
Linux Kernel Mentorship	no	~Jul–Aug	A merged kernel patch is the most portable credential in this document.
Hacktoberfest	no	1–31 Oct	Not a credential. A deadline that makes you start.
24 Pull Requests	no	1–24 Dec	Keeps momentum through the dead month.
GirlScript SoC	no	~Mar	India. High volume, low selectivity — weak signal on its own.

THE PLAN

Five phases between now and next summer. The numbering is a real sequence — each phase is only possible because of the one before it.

01

CHOOSE THE ORGANISATION, NOT THE PROGRAM

SEPTEMBER – OCTOBER 2026

- Shortlist three projects that appear in **three or more** of the programs above. KDE, GNOME, Wikimedia, Rust, Django, Postgres and most CNCF projects all qualify.
- Weight the choice toward a codebase in a language you want to be hired in, and a community whose issue tracker is active *this month* — check the last 30 days of commits, not the star count.
- Build it from source. Read `CONTRIBUTING`. Join the dev list, Matrix or Discord and read the backlog before you post.

Target by 30 Sep — the project builds and its test suite passes on your machine.

02

LAND MERGED PATCHES

OCTOBER – DECEMBER 2026

- Start at `good-first-issue`, then deliberately escalate: a real bug, a test gap, a documentation hole you found yourself.
- Review other people's PRs, triage stale issues, reproduce bug reports. These get you known faster than code does, and almost nobody competing with you will do them.
- Hacktoberfest gives you an October deadline. **The point is what you do on 1 November**, when everyone else stops.

Target by 31 Dec — 6 to 10 merged PRs, and a maintainer who recognises your handle.

03

GET INTO POSITION

JANUARY – EARLY FEBRUARY 2027

- Draft your GSoC proposal months early and **ask a mentor to read it**. A reviewed draft is the difference between the shortlist and the pile.
- Apply to the LFX Spring term — three projects, it costs nothing, and the term starts in March.
- Open and verify a Wise or Payoneer account before you need it. Confirm your bank accepts inbound SWIFT in USD if you're targeting OSPP.
- Check the Outreachy eligibility questions honestly against your situation — the initial application is a gate and it opens in early February.

Target — a mentor-reviewed proposal draft, and a working way to get paid.

04

FIRE EVERYTHING INSIDE THE WINDOW

FEBRUARY – APRIL 2027

- Outreachy initial application (Feb) → contribution period (Feb–Mar) → final application.
- GSoC proposals (late Mar) — submit all three, to the same org if it has three projects you can speak to credibly.
- Igalia (by ~3 Apr), Summer of Bitcoin (Mar), LFX Spring, MLH.
- These do not conflict. **One contribution history, five applications.** Take whichever lands; withdraw from the rest cleanly and early.

Target — five submissions built from one body of work.

05

CONVERT IT INTO THE NEXT THING

MAY 2027 ONWARD

- Finish visibly — write up the work, present it, stay in the project afterwards. Alumni who vanish get no referrals.
- The maintainer network is where remote contract offers come from. Companies that fund open source hire from the contributor list, and they pay in USD or EUR with no visa in the way.
- August–October 2027 is when Summer 2028 internships open at the European offices that *do* sponsor. You'll be applying with merged upstream code — the one credential that reads identically to a recruiter anywhere.

Target — a sponsored offer or a paid remote contract, arrived at without a consulate.

FINE PRINT

- **The 2027 dates are projections.** Everything marked **EST** is extrapolated from the 2026 cycle, because organisers hadn't published 2027 dates yet. Subscribe to each program's announcement list rather than trusting this page in March.
- **Outreachy has real gates** beyond the underrepresentation criterion: no conflicting full-time commitment during the three months, one internship per person ever, and residents of some countries are excluded.
- **Residents of US-sanctioned countries are excluded** from GSoC, Outreachy and other US-administered programs. A legal block, not a policy you can appeal.
- **Purchasing-power adjustment cuts both ways.** LFX moved to a PPP model from a \$6,000 baseline in July 2026 and GSoC has been country-tiered for years, so a lower-cost country means a smaller nominal figure. Worth knowing before you plan around the top of a range.
- **Four of these are region-gated** — C4GT, FOSSEE, GirlScript and Open Summer of Code. Check your eligibility before spending a week on an application.

- **The unpaid programs are not filler.** A merged kernel patch or a Season of KDE project buys you into the organisations that run the paid ones. That is the entire reason they are listed.